

SENATE No. 555

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Cynthia Stone Creem

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to establish a grant and loan program for low-noise, low-emissions landscape maintenance equipment.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

Cynthia Stone Creem

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

Norfolk and Middlesex

SENATE No. 555

By Ms. Creem, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 555) of Cynthia Stone Creem for legislation to establish a grant and loan program for low-noise, low-emissions landscape maintenance equipment. Environment and Natural Resources.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 451 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to establish a grant and loan program for low-noise, low-emissions landscape maintenance equipment.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 21A of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding the following section:

2 Section 29. (a) There shall be within the executive office of energy and environmental
3 affairs a grant and loan program to provide incentive funds to small businesses and
4 municipalities to transition landscape maintenance equipment to low-noise, low-emissions
5 equipment.

6 (b) To be eligible for a grant, small businesses and municipalities shall surrender gas-
7 powered landscape maintenance equipment for a one-for-one replacement with low-noise, low-
8 emissions equipment.

(c) Grant and loan funds awarded pursuant to subsection (a) may be used for:

(1) purchasing electric landscape maintenance equipment;

(2) training landscaping staff on the use and care of electric landscape maintenance equipment;

(3) operational costs that may be accrued through the transition from gas-powered landscape maintenance equipment to electric landscape maintenance equipment; and

(4) any other cost associated with the transition from gas-powered landscape maintenance equipment to electric landscape maintenance equipment, as determined by the secretary.

(e) Loans awarded pursuant to subsection (a) shall carry 0 percent interest.

(f)(1) There is hereby established and set up on the books of the commonwealth a separate fund to be known as the Low-Noise, Low-Emissions Landscape Maintenance Equipment Trust Fund, in this section called the fund. The secretary shall be the trustee of the fund and may expend amounts from the fund without further appropriation.

(2) Amounts credited to the fund shall not be subject to further appropriation and money remaining in the fund at the end of a fiscal year shall not revert to the General Fund and shall be available for expenditure in the subsequent fiscal year.

(3) The secretary shall report annually, on or before August 1, to the house and senate committees on ways and means and the senate and house chairs of the joint committee on environment, natural resources, and agriculture regarding expenditure activity within the trust fund.